

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | KQL | Threat Hunting | L3 Incident Response

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with more than five years of hands-on experience owning and optimising Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) capabilities in complex enterprise environments. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel and the full Microsoft Defender suite, including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, with advanced proficiency in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection engineering, alert tuning, threat hunting, and cost-conscious log source management. At the University of the Arts London, I have led the deployment and ongoing management of Microsoft Sentinel and Defender for Endpoint across more than 8,000 users, engineering detection rules and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, onboarding and managing log sources, and continuously driving down signal-to-noise ratios without sacrificing visibility. I lead Level 3 (L3) incident response for complex, multi-vector threats, conduct advanced threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and design security architecture in Azure and Microsoft 365 using cloud-native controls. I am experienced in mentoring junior security engineers and communicating clearly with stakeholders on cost-versus-coverage trade-offs. I am seeking a permanent hybrid or remote Senior Security Engineer position where I can apply my Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR expertise to shape detection strategy and deliver measurable security outcomes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM):** KQL detection engineering, custom analytics rules, alert tuning, SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps), log source onboarding, ingestion cost management, workbook development
- **Defender XDR (Extended Detection and Response):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Defender for Cloud Apps, advanced hunting queries
- **Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat hunting, hypothesis-driven investigations, detection-as-code, TTP-based alerting
- **Incident Response:** L3 incident response, NIST 800-61 framework, multi-cloud threat correlation, root-cause analysis, post-incident review
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Azure security architecture, cloud-native security controls
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - expert level
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation, alert enrichment workflows
- **Privileged Access Management:** BeyondTrust PAM
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Security Analyst

March 2025 - Present

- Own Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary SIEM, including full management of data connectors, log source onboarding, analytics rules (KQL), SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps), and workbooks; continuously review ingestion costs against coverage requirements to optimise the Sentinel bill without cutting visibility.
- Administer the Microsoft Defender XDR stack (MDE, MDI, Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft 365 Defender) across more than 8,000 users, managing detection policies, threat analytics, and advanced hunting queries to surface and contain threats rapidly.

- Act as L3 escalation point for complex, multi-vector security incidents, leading investigations that correlate signals from Sentinel, Defender XDR, and CrowdStrike Falcon to identify root cause and drive containment and remediation.
- Conduct advanced threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, developing hypothesis-driven hunts in KQL across endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry to proactively surface attacker activity not caught by existing detections.
- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) as a complementary endpoint detection and response platform, building and tuning detection rules and automating response via Falcon Fusion SOAR.
- Design and implement security architecture in Azure and Microsoft 365, configuring Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, identity protection, and cloud-native security controls in Microsoft Entra ID.
- Build and maintain SOAR automation workflows in PowerShell and Logic Apps to enrich alerts, automate triage decisions, and execute containment actions, reducing analyst workload on high-volume, low-complexity alert categories.
- Mentor junior security analysts, reviewing their detections, guiding threat hunting approaches, and developing their KQL and investigative skills through hands-on coaching.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, enforcing least-privilege principles across critical infrastructure and generating audit-ready reports for governance stakeholders.
- Conduct end-to-end vulnerability management using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, translating vulnerability data into prioritised remediation plans and reporting risk reduction to senior leadership.

University of the Arts London (UAL) Senior Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged alerts from Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, investigating triggered analytics rules and hunting for anomalous behaviour across endpoint, identity, and cloud data sources using KQL.
- Contributed to detection engineering, proposing and building new KQL analytics rules in Sentinel to improve detection coverage for threats identified through threat intelligence and threat hunting activity.
- Supported deployment and ongoing optimisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity, onboarding new log sources and validating signal fidelity.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), managing identity lifecycle, MFA roll-out, and Conditional Access policies across a large, diverse user base.
- Participated in incident response activities, conducting log-based investigations in Sentinel and contributing to post-incident reviews and lessons-learned exercises aligned to NIST 800-61.
- Managed vulnerability scanning with Tenable.io and AppCheck, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams and tracking risk metrics over time.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS FinTech) Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed security monitoring and controls across cloud and on-premise infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech organisation, supporting early adoption of SIEM tooling and identity security practices.
- Supported GDPR and data protection compliance, contributing to risk assessments, security policy development, and implementation of technical controls.
- Administered Microsoft 365 and cloud infrastructure, managing identity and access controls and maintaining security of a hybrid environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Owned the full Microsoft Sentinel architecture at UAL, onboarding more than 20 data connectors, building a library of custom KQL analytics rules, and implementing SOAR automation that reduced mean alert triage time significantly.
- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across more than 8,000 users, improving XDR coverage and enabling integrated advanced hunting across the Microsoft Defender stack.
- Developed a Sentinel ingestion cost management framework that identified and removed high-volume, low-value log sources, reducing monthly ingestion costs without compromising detection coverage.

- Managed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR, building detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and creating Falcon Fusion SOAR playbooks that automated containment of common endpoint threats.
- Built a regular threat hunting programme, producing documented hunts with KQL queries, findings, and detection recommendations, directly feeding new analytics rules into Sentinel.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP70,000 - GBP90,000 | Hybrid/Remote (UK)